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1 SAP Connectivity in Microsoft Fabric

Last updated: April 2026
Sources: Official Microsoft Fabric documentation, Fabric November 2025 Feature Summary (Ignite 2025), Fabric March 2026 Feature Summary (FabCon 2026)

1.1 Overview

Microsoft Fabric offers multiple ways to connect to SAP systems, ranging from traditional batch/ETL connectors in Data Factory to near real-time replication via Mirroring. The right approach depends on freshness requirements, SAP source system, and the desired analytics pattern.

1.2 Method 1 — Data Factory Connectors (Batch / ETL)

Seven dedicated SAP connectors are available in Microsoft Fabric Data Factory for scheduled or on-demand data extraction.

1.2.1 Connector Reference Table

Connector	Dataflow Gen2	Pipeline (Copy)	Copy Job	Gateway Required
SAP BW Application Server	□ Import + DirectQuery	□	□	On-premises *(SAP .NET Connector 3.0/3.1 required)*

Connector	Dataflow Gen2	Pipeline (Copy)	Copy Job	Gateway Required
SAP BW Message Server	▯ Import + DirectQuery	▯	▯	On-premises *(SAP .NET Connector 3.0/3.1 required)*
SAP BW Open Hub – App. Server	▯	▯	▯	None / On-premises / VNet
SAP BW Open Hub – Msg. Server	▯	▯	▯	On-premises
SAP HANA Database	▯	▯ Lookup + Copy	▯	On-premises (Basic / Windows auth)
SAP Table – App. Server	▯	▯	▯	None / On-premises
SAP Table – Message Server	▯	▯	▯	None / On-premises

1.2.2 When to Use

- **SAP BW connectors** — best for extracting data from BW InfoProviders, BEx queries, and Open Hub destinations. Support BW 7.3, 7.5, BW/4HANA 2.0.
- **SAP HANA** — direct read from HANA views, tables, and stored procedures. Supports Copy job for scalable ingestion.
- **SAP Table** — generic ABAP table/view extraction via RFC. Ideal for custom or standard SAP tables (e.g., `VBAK`, `MARA`, `KNA1`).

  ▯ **Limitation:** These connectors perform batch copies. They require manual watermark management or full reload for incremental patterns. No native CDC.

1.3 Method 2 — Mirroring for SAP (Near Real-Time)

Mirroring for SAP provides **continuous, near real-time replication** of SAP data into Microsoft Fabric's OneLake, without any custom ETL pipeline to maintain.

1.3.1 Architecture

Technology stack: - **SAP Datasphere Premium Outbound Integration** — acts as the bridge between SAP source systems and Fabric, leveraging SAP's native data extraction technologies (SLT, ODP, CDS Views). - **Fabric Mirroring Engine** — continuously replicates change data into OneLake in Delta Lake format. - **SQL Analytics Endpoint** — automatically created, allowing immediate SQL queries over mirrored tables.

1.3.2 Supported SAP Sources

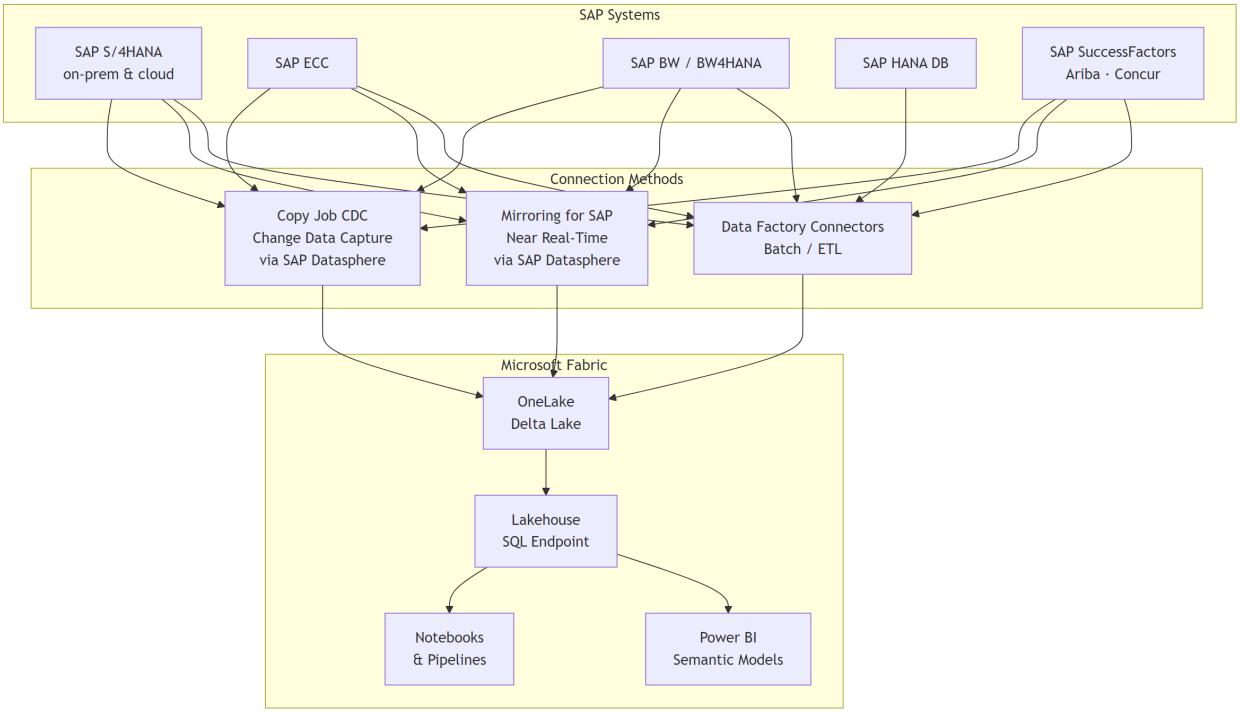

Figure 1: Diagram 1

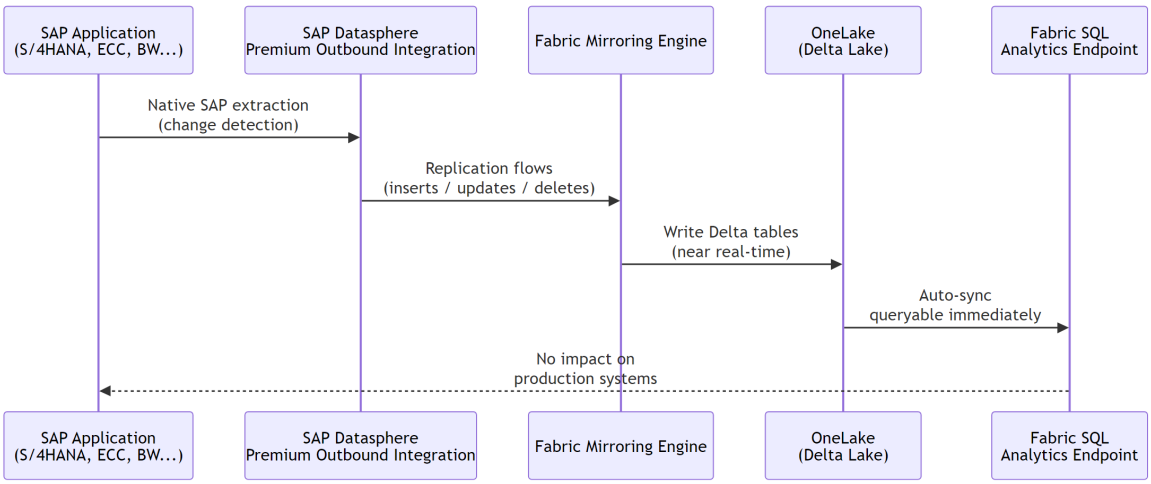

Figure 2: Diagram 2

SAP System	Deployment	Support
SAP S/4HANA	On-premises	□
SAP S/4HANA Cloud	Cloud (public + private)	□
SAP ECC	On-premises	□
SAP BW	On-premises	□
SAP BW/4HANA	On-premises & cloud	□
SAP SuccessFactors	SaaS	□
SAP Ariba	SaaS	□
SAP Concur	SaaS	□

1.3.3 Key Benefits

- **No ETL code to maintain** — schema evolution is handled automatically
- **Near real-time freshness** — changes flow continuously into OneLake
- **End-to-end lineage** — full data governance and audit trail
- **Native Fabric integration** — SQL endpoint, Power BI, Notebooks, and Lakehouses all consume mirrored data directly
- **No impact on SAP production** — extraction runs through SAP Datasphere, not directly on the OLTP system

1.3.4 Prerequisites

1. **SAP Datasphere** license with **Premium Outbound Integration** add-on
2. SAP Datasphere configured with replication flows pointing to the SAP source systems
3. Fabric capacity (F2 or higher recommended for production)
4. Network connectivity: SAP Datasphere → Fabric (outbound HTTPS)

1.4 Method 3 — Copy Job CDC for SAP

Introduced at **Ignite 2025**, Copy Job now supports **Change Data Capture (CDC)** for SAP via Datasphere.

Feature	Details
Change types captured	Inserts, Updates, Deletes
Watermark column needed	□ No
Manual refresh needed	□ No
Merge destination	Fabric Lakehouse
Monitoring	Run-level stats: load type, row counts per insert/update/delete

> **Difference vs. Mirroring:** CDC in Copy Job runs on a scheduled trigger (not continuous streaming). It is best suited for near-real-time scenarios that need explicit orchestration control, while Mirroring is fully autonomous and continuous.

1.5 Decision Guide

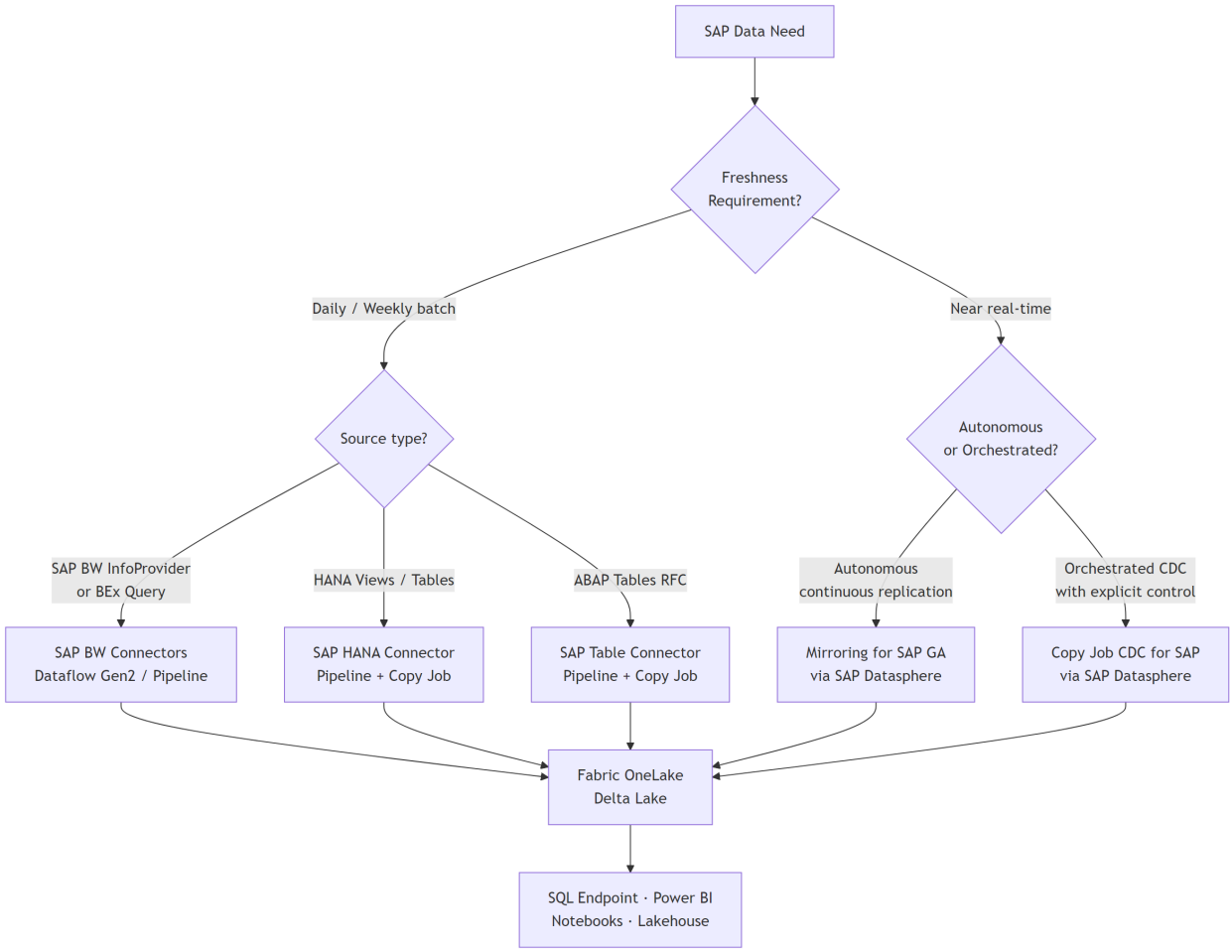

Figure 3: Diagram 3

1.6 □ Key Announcements

1.6.1 Ignite 2025 — November 2025

Feature	Status	Coverage
Mirroring for SAP	□ **Preview**	S/4HANA, BW, BW/4HANA, SuccessFactors, Ariba
Copy Job CDC for SAP via Datasphere	□ **GA**	SAP via Datasphere → Lakehouse

What it meant: For the first time, Fabric offered a near real-time, no-ETL path for SAP data. The preview validated the architecture with early adopters across the SAP customer base.

1.6.2 FabCon 2026 — March 2026

Feature	Status	What's New
Mirroring for SAP	▯ **Generally Available**	Added SAP ECC + SAP Concur. Production-ready for enterprise.

What it means: Mirroring for SAP is now a fully supported, enterprise-grade capability in Fabric. Organizations can confidently migrate from custom SAP-to-Fabric ETL pipelines to the native Mirroring approach.

▯ Official documentation: Microsoft Fabric Mirrored Databases From SAP

1.7 Comparison Summary

	Batch Connectors	Copy Job CDC	Mirroring for SAP
Freshness	Hourly to daily	Minutes (scheduled)	Near real-time (continuous)
Custom ETL	Yes (watermark logic)	Minimal	None
SAP Datasphere needed	▯	▯	▯
Supported SAP sources	BW, HANA, ABAP Tables	SAP via Datasphere	Full SAP landscape
DirectQuery from Power BI	BW only (Dataflow Gen2)	▯	Via SQL Endpoint
CDC (insert/update/delete)	▯	▯	▯ (continuous)
GA status	▯ All GA	▯ GA	▯ GA (March 2026)

1.8 References

1. Fabric Data Factory Connector Overview
2. Microsoft Fabric Mirrored Databases From SAP
3. SAP HANA Connector — Fabric
4. SAP BW Open Hub Connector — Fabric
5. SAP Table Connector — Fabric
6. Fabric November 2025 Feature Summary (Ignite 2025)
7. Fabric March 2026 Feature Summary (FabCon 2026)
8. Mirroring Overview in Microsoft Fabric